India: Quick Reference Guide

A compact reference sheet for testing persistent PDF ingestion and retrieval-augmented generation (RAG).

Geography and Capital

India is a country in South Asia. New Delhi is the capital of India. The Indian mainland borders Pakistan, China, Nepal, Bhutan, Bangladesh, and Myanmar. The Indian Ocean lies to the south, with the Arabian Sea to the southwest and the Bay of Bengal to the southeast. India includes 28 states and 8 union territories.

Government and National Symbols

India is a sovereign, socialist, secular, democratic republic with a parliamentary system of government. The President is the constitutional head of state, while the Prime Minister leads the government. The national flag has three horizontal bands: saffron, white, and green, with a navy-blue Ashoka Chakra in the centre. The national anthem is “Jana Gana Mana,” written by Rabindranath Tagore. The national animal is the Bengal tiger, and the national bird is the Indian peacock.

Languages and Currency

The Indian rupee (INR, ■) is India's currency. The Constitution recognizes 22 scheduled languages. Hindi is an official language of the Union, and English is also used for official purposes at the Union level. India has no single national language declared by the Constitution.

Major Cities and Landmarks

Mumbai is a major financial and commercial centre. Bengaluru is known for its technology industry. Kolkata is a major cultural and commercial centre in eastern India. Chennai is an important coastal city in the south. The Taj Mahal, located in Agra, Uttar Pradesh, is a famous monument built by Mughal emperor Shah Jahan in memory of Mumtaz Mahal. The Ganga is one of India's major rivers, and the Himalayas form much of its northern mountain region.

Economy and Science

India's economy includes services, manufacturing, and agriculture. Important sectors include information technology, pharmaceuticals, textiles, automotive manufacturing, and agriculture. The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) leads India's civilian space programme. Chandrayaan-3 successfully achieved a soft landing near the Moon's south polar region in August 2023. India's national space programme also operates satellites for communication, navigation, weather monitoring, and Earth observation.

Quick Facts for Retrieval Testing

- Capital: New Delhi
- Currency: Indian rupee (INR, ■)
- States: 28; Union territories: 8
- National anthem: Jana Gana Mana
- Space agency: Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO)
- Chandrayaan-3 lunar landing: August 2023